

tracewell



Open-source distributed tracing

Apache-2.0, built in the open

See every request, end to end.

For the backend engineers and SREs who are asked where the time went, Tracewell is the open-source tracer that follows one request through every service it touches and draws the answer as a waterfall. It runs on their own infrastructure, speaks OpenTelemetry, and keeps no feature behind a key.

Concept: where the milliseconds went. Every surface shows a request crossing services, and one span that took too long.

Audience

Backend engineers and SREs choosing a tracing tool, at work on a laptop with a second screen.

Platform teams who must keep span data inside their own network.

Readers arriving from a GitHub README, often on a phone, who decide in one screen.

Archetype

The Sage

Knowledge through evidence. Tracewell shows the trace instead of claiming speed; the waterfall is the argument, and the slow span is found, not guessed.

Voice

`payments.charge took 96 ms, 2.1× its p99.`

One line to instrument.

There is nothing on this page to buy.

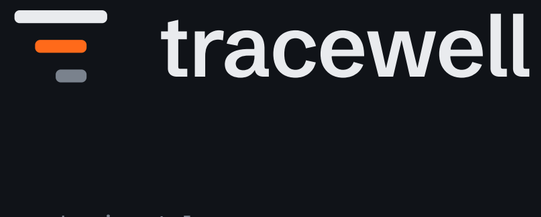
~~Supercharge your observability.~~

The waterfall is the argument.

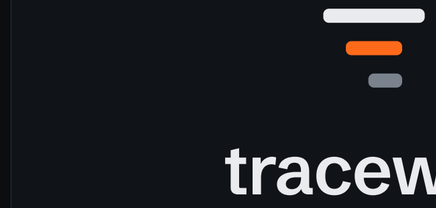


The mark is a trace waterfall. Three spans, each starting inside its parent and ending before it does. The orange child is the slow one: the span the product exists to find.

bar	2.5 units high, 1 unit corner, the site's 2px span bar at scale
pitch	5.75 units from bar to bar, so the three read as rows
offsets	1, 5 and 9 units: each child is nested, never centred
colour	ink, signal orange, the third ink; never two orange bars



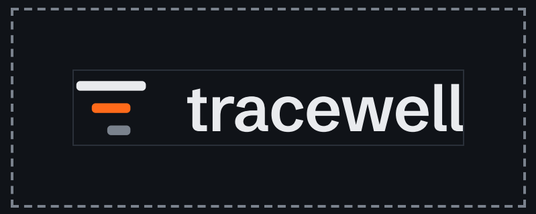
Primary, horizontal



Stacked



Symbol: colour, one colour, reversed



Clear space: one root span's length



lockup 96 px

symbol 16 px

Minimum size



recoloured

two signals

span outside parent

rotated

Incorrect uses

Signal
#FF6A1A, the slow span, the primary action, the focus ring

Ground
#0B0D10

Panel
#101318

Line
#2A3039

Ink
#E9EBEE

Ink 2
#A3AAB4

Ink 3
#7A828D

See every request

Söhne, the brand face, for display and interface; set here in Schibsted Grotesk, its open stand-in, at -0.045em on display sizes.

`payments.charge 96 ms`

JetBrains Mono for data only: service names, durations, trace ids, commands. Never on a label that carries no figure.

Corners 4px on controls and panels, 2px on span bars. No shadows: elevation by lightness, from ground to panel to line.

tracewell

See every request, end to end.

Repository social card

tracewell

licence Apache-2.0 | otlp native | release v0.9

Follow a request through every service it touches and see where the milliseconds went.

```
$ npm i @tracewell/sdk
```

README header

```
$ tracewell up
collector listening on :4318 (OTLP/HTTP)
ui ready on http://localhost:7070
storage postgres, retention 7 days
GET /checkout  212 ms  7 spans
 orders.load-cart      38 ms
 payments.charge       96 ms p99×2.1
```

CLI



Sticker sheet

tracewell

Quick start
Node
Python
Go
Sampling
Storage

Instrument a Node service

One call at start-up wraps HTTP, gRPC, queues and SQL.

```
import { trace } from
"@tracewell/sdk";
trace.init({ service: "orders" });
```

Docs

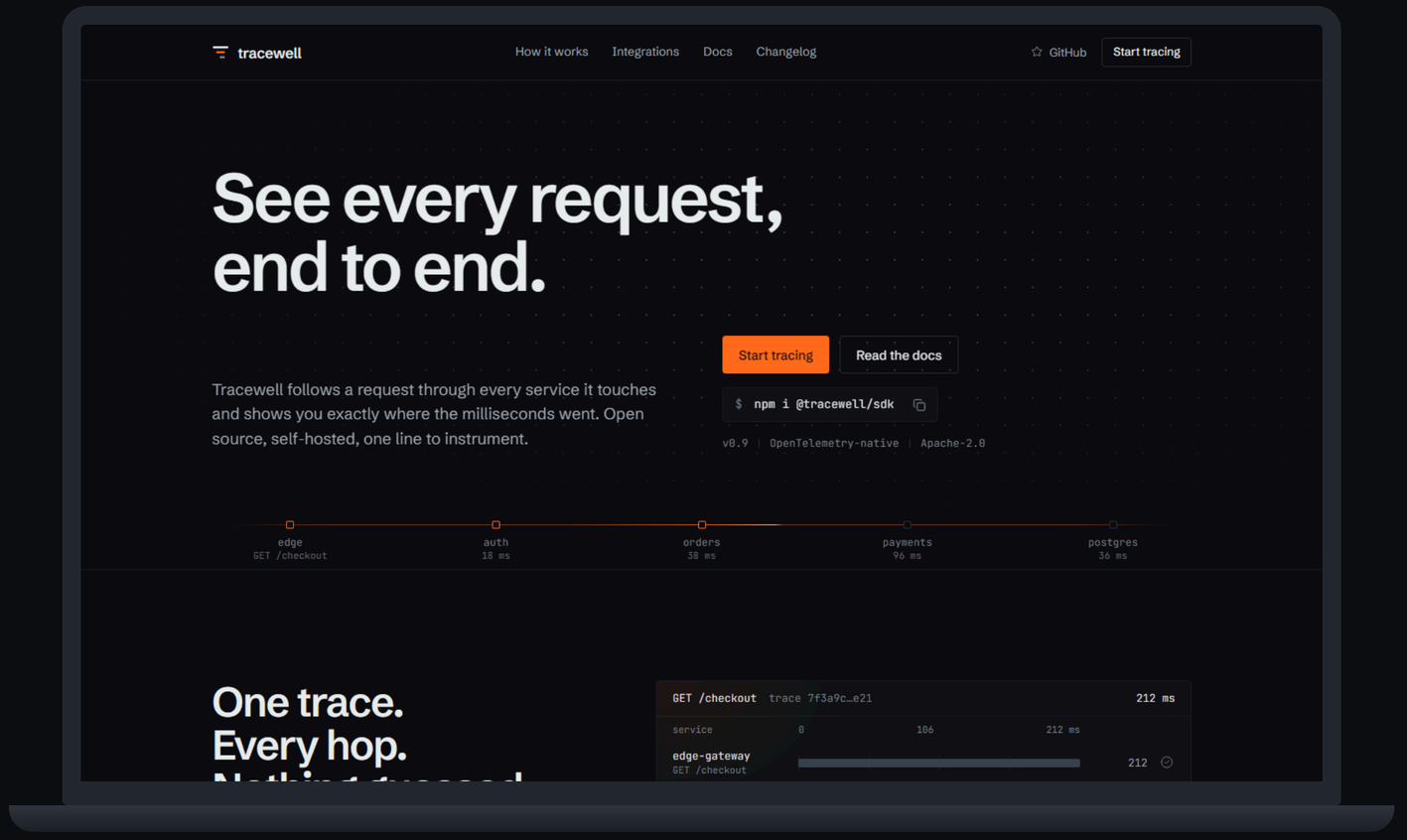
GET /nowhere 404

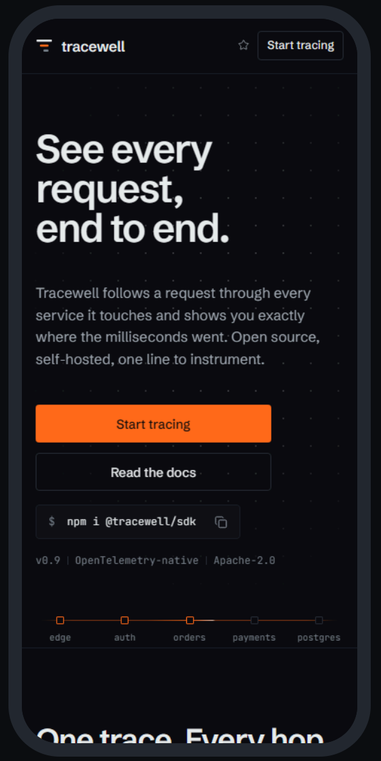
Trace not found.

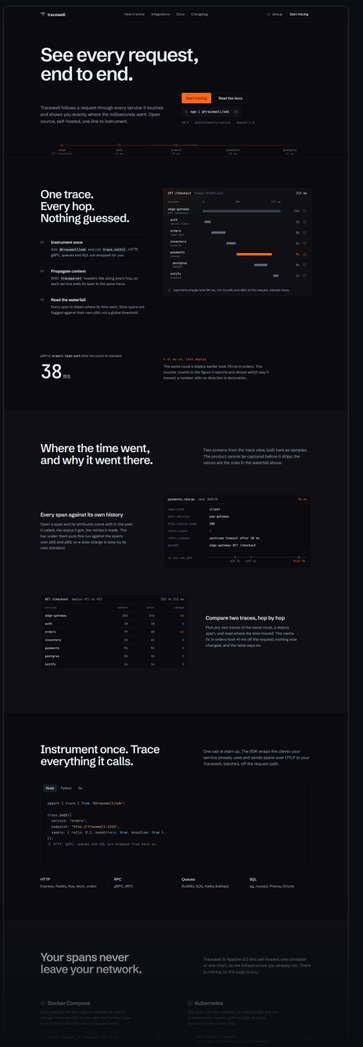
edge 4 ms
router 1 ms
this page —

Error page

site/index.html







Desktop 1440, phone 390, the full page

Start tracing in one line.

```
$ npm i @tracewell/sdk
```

tracewell